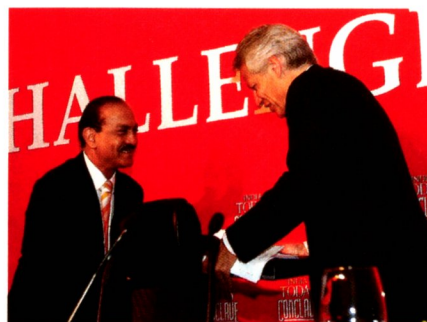


That is why the international community should agree on a common obligation to ease cooperation and quicken procedures. World-wide legislation is the third tool to fight terrorism. The UN must be at the centre of all common efforts. As of now, a dozen different texts are in application. We lack a global convention, which is stalled by problems of the definition of terrorism.

Intelligence has to be shared more effectively. And this has been a strong feature of the French-Indian strategic partnership. Facing terrorism, states must learn to share information and resources, for example in the field of interception. How can we respect free speech and be sure that the internet, cellphones, GPS are not used for terrorist ends? We need international directives to monitor these networks.

The fight also has to focus on financial aspects because terrorism needs depositories to act. Institutions like the Financial Action Task Force have worked on international norms so as to control illegal money transfers effectively.

But how can we eradicate terrorism? There are three traps we must avoid falling into. The first trap is to wage a merciless war. The second is fear. Confronted with the horror of terrorist acts, we may be tempted to make an exception and go beyond democratic laws. I am sure this approach is a dead-end. The third trap is to count solely on the use of force. We all dream of living in a world free of fear of such attacks. In this context, the use of military force may seem essential. We saw it in Afghanistan. The difficulty lies in effectively combining the use of force with all the other means at our disposal. A mil-



MANAGING EDITOR AND SESSION CHAIRPERSON
RAJ CHENGAPPA (LEFT) WITH DOMINIQUE DE VILLEPIN

itary alliance would risk to falling in all three of them. Avoiding these traps is crucial.

There are no shortcuts. We must build a new world order. This means finding common principles and putting the dialogue of cultures at the core. I want to say I am absolutely convinced that together we will see an end to terrorism. It's a question of resolve and lucidity. Resolve, because, to thwart future attacks, political leaders must be mobilised, intelligence services must work night and day, the best technological means must be used and citizens must be vigilant. Lucidity, because we face a movement that is one step ahead of us, which has to be reversed. We must act now. We must mobilise now and work towards world unity.

For full text and discussion, click to:
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DISCUSSION

Q. We have had a major terror attack in Mumbai. Pakistan has now admitted its complicity, but India has been restrained in its response. If there is another major attack, what do you think India should do? Go to war?

A. Terrorists would like India to go to war. They would like you to use force against Pakistan and mess everything up. That is their strategy and you have to always understand if you go to war you would be creating more frustration and more wounds. It's exactly what happened

when the US hit between Pakistan and Afghanistan. So I believe the global strategy against terrorism should include better cooperation between countries and judicial use of police. Using military force is never an answer.

Q. Over the years we have seen that terrorism is mostly found in authoritarian countries, and it's the democracies who suffer. What kind of dialogue and co-operation would you recommend?

A. You have to have a strong institution in these countries to put

the state of law, police and the army in a stronger position and have them respect common and effective principles. India's problem lies in its relationship with Pakistan. It needs to get cooperation through the channel of exchanging intelligence and cooperation from different countries, like the US and Europe.

Q. As Obama gets increasingly distracted in the twin challenges of security and managing the challenge of the economic meltdown, do you think it will see an increase in terrorism?

A. I believe, in this atmosphere of economic and financial crisis, we may have more cases of violence because there is a lot of injustice and the key agenda of any political strategy in all of our countries is to stop this injustice. If we don't change our motivations in government, business and how to govern a society, then violence will become stronger and these networks that are feeding themselves off the humiliation and frustration of people and poverty will become stronger and stronger.